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How Can I Download a File from EC2 [closed]



What `scp` arguments should I use to download a file from an Amazon EC2 instance to local storage?

amazon-ec2 scp

edited Apr 16 '15 at 23:00



Anirvan

3,957 3 24 46

asked Feb 25 '12 at 3:45



user1226621

155 1 2 4

closed as off topic by [smparkes](#), [Eric J.](#), [Nishant](#), [Steffen Opel](#), [Joe](#) Feb 25 '12 at 19:42

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If this question can be reworded to fit the rules in the [help center](#), please [edit the question](#).

Do you mean on an instance running in the EC2 environment? If so, is it Windows or Linux? Or do you mean a file on S3? – [Eric J.](#) Feb 25 '12 at 3:48

Did `scp` not work? It does very well for me. – [Nishant](#) Feb 25 '12 at 4:00

I have a file generalized from EC2, so it is now in EC2 and wanna transfer it to my computer. The EC2 environment is LINUX. – [user1226621](#) Feb 25 '12 at 4:15

@Nishant how does it work? – [user1226621](#) Feb 25 '12 at 4:22

[this answer](#) explains how. – [Nishant](#) Feb 25 '12 at 5:21

2 Answers

Use `scp`:

```
scp -i ec2key.pem username@ec2ip:/path/to/file .
```

where:

- `ec2key.pem` is your PEM key
- `username` is the username you log in with
- `ec2ip` is the IP or DNS alias of the instance
- `/path/to/file` is the location where the file is stored

This will copy the file into the current folder on the local machine.

You can read more here on how to access your instance with `ssh` if you haven't done already:

- <http://docs.aws.amazon.com/gettingstarted/latest/computebasics-linux/getting-started-deploy-app-connect-linux.html>

When you are able to `ssh` as in the above doc, you will be able to use `scp` to copy the file.

Another option is to bring up some Web server on your instance, configure HTTPS if your file is sensitive and then download using your browser, here are some tutorials:

- http://flurdy.com/docs/ec2/apache_tomcat/
- <http://www.robotmedia.net/2011/04/how-to-create-an-amazon-ec2-instance-with-apache-php-and-mysql-lamp/>

edited Jun 23 '13 at 4:13

answered Feb 25 '12 at 3:49



Gopal

144 1 15



icyrock.com

16.8k 1 29 57

Won't this **send** a file TO amazon? What if I want to get the file from there? – [gideon](#) Jan 20 '13 at 11:41

- 2 @gideon No, it won't. Basic syntax for `scp` is `scp from_file to_file`. In the above, `from_file` is `username@ec2ip:/path/to/file` and `to_file` is `.`, i.e. current folder. To sent to ec2, it would have to be something along the lines: `scp local_file username@ec2ip:/path/on/ec2/machine .` – [icyrock.com](#) Jan 20 '13 at 18:39

Ah. Could you help me with this then. When I try it with my ec2 server it doesn't work!! `scp -rp -i mykey.pem ec2-user@mydomain.com:/srv/www/myapp/ .` It just ends up downloading/copying the folder to my ec2 machine home directory. – [gideon](#) Jan 21 '13 at 2:36

- 1 @gideon That definitely should work as expected (i.e. recursively copy all files from `/srv/www/myapp/` to the local machine). Wild guess - are you running `scp` from your ec2 server perhaps? If yes, you need to run it from your local machine (i.e. the machine you want to copy files to). – [icyrock.com](#) Jan 21 '13 at 5:12

shoot! Yes I was silly enough to think it would work like that! :) Thanks a million! – [gideon](#) Jan 21 '13 at 6:35



If you are using Mac or Linux you can use `scp` or even more friendly, download an FTP client, if you are on Mac I recommend you to use [CyberDuck](#). In the end all you need is an FTP client. If you are on Windows I would recommend you [Filezilla](#).

What OS are you in?

Since you are in Ubuntu, try this:

Connect to a file server + In the file manager, click File ▶ Connect to Server.

- Enter the server address, select the type of server, and enter any additional information as required. Then click Connect. Details on server types are listed below.
- For servers on the internet, you can usually use the domain name. For computers on your local area network, however, you may have to use the computer's numeric IP address. If the other computer is running Ubuntu, see Find your IP address to find that computer's internal IP address. Otherwise, check the help on that computer.
- A new window will open showing you the files on the server. Browse the files and folders just as you would for local files and folders.

edited Feb 29 at 6:34

answered Feb 25 '12 at 3:49



Kirtikumar A.

2,172 21 28



El Developer

2,895 1 12 31

My os is a vmware Ubuntu. so I need a FTP client, and could you tell me what to do next? – [user1226621](#) Feb 25 '12 at 4:30

You can probably try this tutorial help.ubuntu.com/11.04/ubuntu-help/nautilus-connect.html I have updated my answer with a quote to the site tutorial. – [El Developer](#) Feb 25 '12 at 4:45

For copying over one or two file, you could just move it to the web folder and just acces it through the browser and just download it form there. for bulk files try the other suggestions – [lost child](#) Oct 28 '15 at 13:56